



PHILIPPINES

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 9 JULY 2026 - 15 JULY 2026

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The Philippines operating picture eased a little this week, though from a high baseline, with higher-severity reporting across natural hazards, armed robbery and violent crime and other security-relevant activity. Metro Manila (NCR), Visayas and Mindanao remain the main exposure for staff movement and site continuity. Business users should tighten movement planning, review movement routines and premises security and monitor localised fire, utility and transport disruption and check site continuity.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

Rescue operations in Lanao del Sur landslide site suspended

HIGH

Armed robbery / violent crime · Bangsamoro · Reported 10 Jul 2026 · Philippine Daily Inquirer

Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.

Widespread flooding leaves 2 dead in Bukidnon

LOW

Armed robbery / violent crime · Northern Mindanao · Reported 10 Jul 2026 · Philippine Daily Inquirer

Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.

US reports 'wave of strikes' on Iran as war returns

MODERATE

Other security · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Philippine Daily Inquirer

Security-relevant development; monitor for operational follow-on in the affected area.

INCIDENT DETAILS

PROTEST & CIVIL UNREST

Protest activity and the crowd-control response to it were reported, including protest. It concentrated in Metro Manila and Central Visayas. The most serious reported was Ayala Bridge, key Manila roads shut for UPI rally (Metro Manila), assessed as Moderate severity. Gatherings and the response to them can close roads and disrupt access at short notice.

CRIME, THEFT & ROBBERY

Crime, theft and violent incidents were reported, including armed robbery and crime. It concentrated in Metro Manila, Eastern Visayas and Bangsamoro. The most serious reported was Who is Kent Carpenter? The marine biologist whose work backed PH arbitral win, assessed as High severity. Incidents of this kind threaten staff, premises and the movement of cash and assets.

NATURAL HAZARDS

Natural-hazard and environmental disruption was reported, including natural hazard. It concentrated in Metro Manila, Central Visayas and Davao Region. The most serious reported was Typhoon Inday topples trees, crushes vehicles in Baguio (Cordillera Administrative Region), assessed as High severity. Hazards of this kind can interrupt transport, utilities and site access.

GOVERNANCE & REGULATORY

Policing, regulatory and political-stability activity was reported, including regulatory and security force activity. It concentrated in Eastern Visayas and Metro Manila. The most serious reported was Sara Duterte impeachment trial Day 5: 'Admission against interest' clashes with 'no threat' defense (Eastern Visayas), assessed as High severity. Regulatory, policing and political-stability friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement.

OTHER OPERATIONAL DISRUPTION

Operational disruption to transport, utilities or connectivity was reported, including other security and transport disruption. It concentrated in

Central Visayas, Western Visayas and Cordillera Administrative Region. The most serious reported was Girl, 14, dies shielding cousins from snake attack (Soccsksargen), assessed as High severity. Disruption of this kind can interrupt operations, logistics and connectivity.

CURRENT SITUATION

Activity this week concentrated on natural hazards, armed robbery and violent crime and other security-relevant activity, concentrated around Metro Manila (NCR), Visayas and Mindanao. The main business impact is direct exposure to violence and major disruption at affected sites. The reporting picture this week reads as broad and improving.

OPERATIONAL IMPACT

Protest & civil unrest — Gatherings and crowd-control responses can close roads and disrupt access at short notice; build in transit buffers and keep routes flexible.

Crime, theft & robbery — Direct threat to staff, premises and the movement of cash or assets; harden security, vary routines and brief travellers.

Natural hazards — Weather and geological hazards can interrupt transport, utilities and site access; check conditions before movement and confirm site readiness.

Governance & regulatory — Regulatory, policing and political-stability friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement; monitor official guidance.

Fire & explosion — Fires and explosions cause localised damage and forced evacuation around affected sites; confirm site status before approach.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

Nationally: Monitor hazard and flood warnings; check site access, drainage and continuity arrangements. Escalation trigger — an official flood, storm or seismic warning upgrade, or an airport or port closure.

Metro Manila (NCR): Avoid protest locations, allow extra journey time and keep routes flexible. Escalation trigger — a call for mass mobilisation, a march on government or company premises, or clashes with police.

Visayas: Monitor hazard and flood warnings; check site access, drainage and continuity arrangements. Escalation trigger — an official flood, storm or seismic warning upgrade, or an airport or port closure.

Mindanao: Monitor hazard and flood warnings; check site access, drainage and continuity arrangements. Escalation trigger — an official flood, storm or seismic warning upgrade, or an airport or port closure.

Visayas: Maintain standard movement and continuity precautions; monitor for operational follow-on. Escalation trigger — a higher-severity or casualty-bearing incident, or repeat activity in the same area.

OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

The coming week most likely follows the current pattern, led by natural hazards, with violent crime also likely to recur. Key locations to watch: Metro Manila and Central Visayas.

Escalation triggers: a spread of high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents beyond the locations above, and flashpoints around political mobilisation, security operations in Mindanao and the Bangsamoro region, and the typhoon and seismic-hazard calendar.

Concern would ease with a sustained quiet stretch across Metro Manila and Central Visayas, no further high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents, and no spread to new districts. Were the picture to deteriorate, expect direct disruption to movement and site access at the affected locations, with knock-on delays to staff travel and logistics.

ESCALATION INDICATORS

Larger or coordinated protest mobilisation, or labour action spreading to key sites and corridors

Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence at or near operating sites

Spread of incidents beyond Metro Manila (NCR) and Visayas into new districts

REPORTED UPCOMING ACTIVITY

- Road blockade / sit-in: Validate against logistics corridor; pre-position alternative routings. (reported 15 Jul 2026).
- Civic protest march (Cebu): Treat as leading indicator; confirm operating impact inside 24-48h. (reported 13 Jul 2026).
- Civic protest march (Manila): Treat as leading indicator; confirm operating impact inside 24-48h. (reported 13 Jul 2026).
- Sectoral strike notice: Supply-chain friction and sectoral closures 24-72h ahead. (reported 11 Jul 2026).
- Businessman, companion found dead in Victorias: Treat as leading indicator; confirm operating impact inside 24-48h. (reported 10 Jul 2026).
- Civic protest march: Treat as leading indicator; confirm operating impact inside 24-48h. (reported 09 Jul 2026).

Forward-looking signals drawn from reporting that announces scheduled or planned activity. Dates shown are announcement dates, not confirmed event dates.

POLESTAR VIEW

Polestar assesses that operating risk in Philippines is easing, though from an elevated baseline, driven by natural-hazard disruption, crime and violent incidents and transport and utility disruption. The main business exposure is business continuity, logistics and staff safety. The most exposed areas are Metro Manila (NCR), Visayas and Mindanao. The most likely disruption over the next seven days is further natural-hazard disruption to transport and site access. The assessment would worsen if larger-scale incidents, casualty-bearing violence or sustained disruption emerge around political mobilisation, security operations in Mindanao and the Bangsamoro region, and the typhoon and seismic-hazard calendar. For now, operators should tighten movement planning and site protection at the exposed locations and keep contingency arrangements under active review.

Operational Map

Reported operational issues this period



● Direct impact ● Indirect impact ● Monitor only

● Cotabato Impact level: Indirect impact What happened this period: GMA Kapuso Foundation gives food packs, hygiene kits to earthquake victims in South Cotabato Business relevance: Possible site or utility disruption if operating nearby	● Manila Impact level: Direct impact What happened this period: Ayala Bridge, key Manila roads shut for UPI rally Business relevance: Confirmed movement and access disruption	● Cebu Impact level: Indirect impact What happened this period: How the Badjao read the sea: Indigenous knowledge in disaster plans Business relevance: Possible site or utility disruption if operating nearby
● Davao Impact level: Indirect impact What happened this period: After rain and		

flood, Davao Occidental gets hit by magnitude 6.3 earthquake

Business relevance: Possible site or utility disruption if operating nearby

Points show reported events at the town or province named in the reporting; where several share a location one marker carries the count. A marker is a town or province-level fix, not an exact point. 71 of 109 records name no specific place and are included in the totals and tables but not plotted.

Map Read

This map shows reported operationally relevant issues for the current reporting period. Not every security or crime incident creates commercial impact. Direct impact is used only where reporting shows a current or confirmed effect on operations, movement, access, site security, utilities, production, logistics, workforce safety or business continuity. Indirect impact marks issues relevant to the operating environment with no confirmed effect on a client site, route, workforce, movement, production, access, utilities or logistics. Background incidents, preparedness meetings, isolated crime, political or legal developments, corruption investigations and general policing are Monitor only unless a clear operational effect is reported.

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